

DuoVox

User Guide

Real-time transcription & translation • Windows 10 & 11

David Arthur Software
duovox.net

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1. Welcome

DuoVox transcribes speech in real time and translates it on the fly, so two people who don't share a language can follow a live, two-way conversation on a single Windows PC. It is built for interpreters, clinics, classrooms, support desks, businesses and families.

As each person speaks, DuoVox shows a live transcript of what was said and, alongside it, a running translation. It can caption a call or video playing on your computer, or your own microphone.

This guide covers everything from your first session to the built-in tools. Use the clickable Contents page (or your PDF reader's bookmarks panel) to jump to any section.

2. Installation & First Run

- **Microsoft Store (recommended)** — one-click install, automatic updates, signed by Microsoft. Find it from duovox.net.
- **Direct download** — a self-contained installer is also available from the website for offline PCs.

On first launch the interface appears in your Windows display language where supported (15 languages are available); you can change it any time from the globe icon in the toolbar.

***Tip:** DuoVox works straight away on the Free plan with on-device engines — no account or internet connection required to get started.*

3. The Main Window

The caption panels fill the middle of the window. The toolbar across the top holds the menu (gear icon), the display-language globe, a privacy padlock and the window controls, together with the everyday session controls — Topic and Dialect, the two language selectors, Start / Clear, the layout button and the audio source. A footer shows the version and links. Drag the window by its top bar; resize from the edges.

The menu

Press the gear button (top-right) and a panel slides out with everything grouped into **Files**, **Current session**, **Display**, **Accuracy** and **Settings & advanced** — followed further down by Keyboard shortcuts, User guide, Help, Report a problem and About DuoVox. Under Display, open **Appearance** to change the theme, buttons, font and caption text size. Press Esc or click outside the panel to close it.

4. Starting a Session

Set your audio source, then press **Start** (or Ctrl+Alt+S). DuoVox begins listening and filling the caption panels. Press **Stop** to end the session.

Choosing the audio source

The toolbar shows what DuoVox is currently listening to (for example "Listening to: System audio"). Click that button to cycle through the available sources:

- **System Audio** — captions a call, meeting or video playing on your PC (Teams, Zoom, YouTube, etc.).
- **Desk Mic** or **Headset Mic** — captions your own voice through a desk or headset microphone. The button cycles through all three sources in turn.
- If you see a "no audio" message, switch the source so it matches where the sound is actually coming from.

5. Primary & Target Languages

DuoVox works with two language lanes: a **primary** language and a **target** language. Set them from the two language selectors in the toolbar — the first picks the primary language, the second the target (for example, primary English and target Ukrainian). Either lane can be any supported language, in any direction: DuoVox is fully language-agnostic, so it works for conversations anywhere in the world.

- **2-box mode** — shows one speaker and the translation; you can flip the direction with a button.
- **4-box mode** — shows both speakers transcribed and translated at once, ideal for a true two-way conversation.

The globe icon is separate — it changes the language of DuoVox's own menus and buttons, not the conversation languages.

6. Topic & Dialect

Two selectors in the toolbar help DuoVox recognise the right words for your conversation. Each has an information (i) button beside it that explains it inside the app.

- **Topic** — the subject of the conversation (General / Housing / Finance, Medical / Mental Health, Legal / Immigration / Police, or Education). DuoVox favours that field's specialist vocabulary so terms are transcribed more accurately.
- **Dialect** — the region or country, so spelling and word choice match local usage (for example British versus American English).

7. Translation & Layout

Turn **Translate** on to show translations beside the transcript; turn it off for transcription only. Toggle between 4 boxes and 2 boxes with the layout button (Ctrl+Alt+R).

- **Pin on top** (menu > Display) keeps the DuoVox window above other apps (Ctrl+Alt+T).
- **Copy** copies the current text; **Export this session** (menu > Current session) saves .srt subtitles plus a transcript.
- **Clear** resets the captions and the subtitle clock (Ctrl+Alt+C).

8. Appearance — Themes, Fonts & Display

Open the menu, then **Display > Appearance**. Pick from a wide range of **Themes** (the DA Software purple is the default), choose a **Button** style, and set the caption **Font** and **text size**. Your choices are remembered between sessions.

9. Plans & Offline Mode

DuoVox offers a Free plan and paid plans, and it is designed never to leave you stuck:

- **Free** — runs fully offline on your device with on-device AI. Unlimited use, no internet needed, supported by ads.
- **Standard / Professional** — premium online AI for the highest accuracy, with a set number of hours included each month.
- **Pay-As-You-Go** — buy online AI hours individually, with no subscription.

If your internet drops or you reach your monthly hours, DuoVox keeps working in free offline on-device mode for the rest of the session — you are never automatically charged. When you reach a cap you simply choose: buy more hours, continue offline, or end the session.

Tip: Offline mode is lower quality than the premium online engines but needs no connection, so a dropped Wi-Fi signal never interrupts an important conversation.

10. Tools

Open the menu (gear icon) for the built-in tools, grouped by area:

- **Files** — **Subtitle a video or audio file** (transcribe, and optionally translate, an existing media file, then export .srt or .vtt) and **Translate a document** (a TXT, PDF or DOCX file).
- **Current session** — **Export this session** saves the live conversation you are running now as .srt subtitles plus a transcript.
- **Accuracy** — **Glossary** and **Boost keywords** teach DuoVox specialist vocabulary (medical, legal, technical) so names and terms are recognised accurately.
- **Settings & advanced** — **Download Languages** (opens the Language Packs window to get and manage the on-device models used in offline mode), the audio input device and other advanced options.

Getting subtitles in sync

Inside the file-subtitling window there is a **Sync offset** field that shifts every exported subtitle in time. If the subtitles appear a little late against your video, enter a negative number of seconds (for example -0.5) to pull them earlier; enter a positive number if they appear early. Use the – and + buttons to nudge it, then export .srt or .vtt as usual.

11. Privacy

Audio is transcribed in real time. It is not sold, and it is never stored beyond your session. Turn on **Private Mode** with the padlock toggle in the toolbar: it clears the captions when you stop and disables copy and export. Offline modes run entirely on your device with no internet connection at all.

12. Keyboard Shortcuts

- **Ctrl+Alt+S** — Start / Stop
- **Ctrl+Alt+C** — Clear (reset subtitle clock)
- **Ctrl+Alt+E** — Export this session (.srt + transcript)
- **Ctrl+Alt+T** — Pin on top / Unpin
- **Ctrl+Alt+R** — Toggle 4 boxes / 2 boxes

13. Support & Contact

Questions or feedback are always welcome — email info@duovox.net and every message is read. You can also visit duovox.net for the latest news, the privacy policy and the terms of service.

The menu also has a **Report a problem** option. It sends your description of what happened along with the app version and error counters — conversation text, translations, audio and your files are all stripped out — and reports are deleted automatically after 30 days.

If DuoVox helps you, an optional “Buy me a coffee” keeps a small independent studio going. Thank you for using DuoVox.